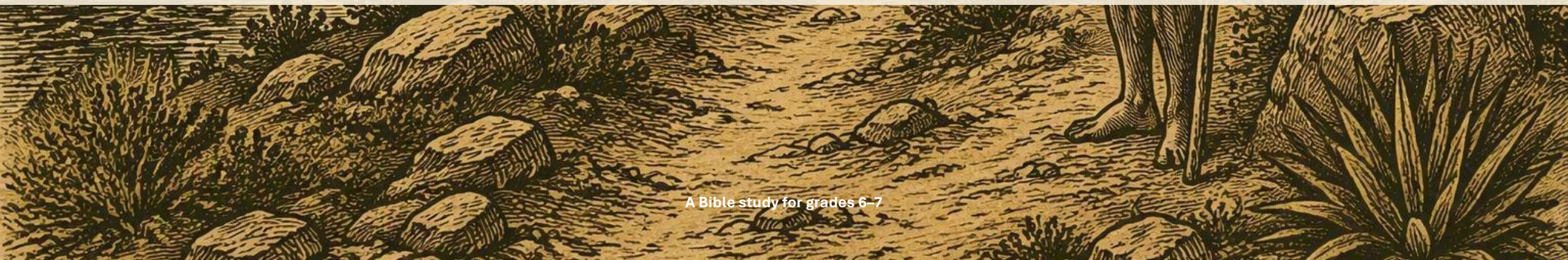




MARK 1

Prepare the Way

Good News • A straight path • A changed heart



A Bible study for grades 6-7

A Gospel Written for Courage

John Mark

Mark's full name was John Mark. He wrote for Christians in Rome during a dangerous time.

The message was clear: even when the world feels frightening, Jesus is still the Good News.



AD 64

Persecution under Emperor Nero

AD 70

Jerusalem is destroyed

The First Line Tells the Whole Story

VERSE 1

“The gospel of Jesus Christ, the Son of God.”

GOOD NEWS

GOSPEL

**“Good News”
or “Glad Tidings”**

JESUS CHRIST

**The Gospel is
about a Person.**

SON OF GOD

**Jesus is more
than a teacher.**

Every other religion is about what you need to do to earn salvation. Christianity is about what God has already done for you i.e. the good news (Gospel)

Two Prophets Point to One Messenger

MALACHI

The latest prophet

“Behold, I send My messenger before Your face...”

ISAIAH

The longest prophetic book

“The voice of one crying in the wilderness...”

The wilderness reminds us of Israel traveling through the desert toward Canaan.

ONE PROMISE → GOD PREPARES THE WAY

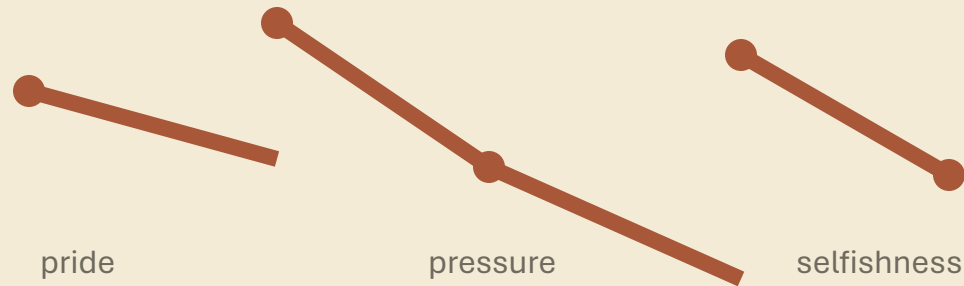


Jesus Makes a Straight Way

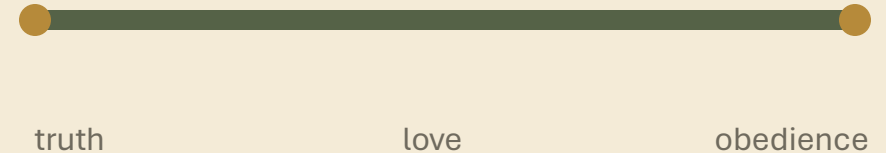
VERSE 3

“Prepare the way of the Lord; make His paths straight.”

CROOKED WAYS OF THE WORLD



THE WAY OF CHRIST



“Straight” does not mean easy. It means our lives point toward Christ instead of following every twist of the world.

REFLECT What is one choice that can point you toward Jesus this week?

Repentance Means a Real Turn



VERSE 4

“A baptism of repentance for the remission of sins.”

1

REPENT

Turn away from sin and turn toward God.

2

REMISSION

Forgiveness—the guilt of sin is taken away.

3

RENEWAL

God renews our hearts and reforms our lives.

John Points Beyond Himself

John lived differently on purpose.

Camel-hair clothing • leather belt • locusts • wild honey

His simple life showed that God’s Good News is counter-cultural: we do not have to copy every influence around us.

VERSE 7

“There comes One after me who is mightier than I.”

Jesus called John the greatest born of women—yet John stayed humble and pointed everyone to Jesus.

v8 “I baptized you with water, but He will baptize you with the Holy Spirit.”



WATER cleans the outside

HOLY SPIRIT cleanses the soul

The Baptism Reveals Humility

VERSE 9

“Jesus came from Nazareth of Galilee, and was baptized by John in the Jordan.”

Jesus did not need forgiveness.

He chose baptism to show humility and to stand with us.

THE HEAVENS OPEN

Like a door opening for its true Owner, heaven opens as the Son arrives.

2 Corinthians 5:19

The sinless One came to save sinners.



The Wilderness Is Not God's Absence



40

DAYS

VERSE 13

“He was there in the wilderness forty days, tempted by Satan ... and the angels ministered to Him.”

TEMPTED

but not abandoned

When life is hard, God has not left us. We stay close through prayer and discipline.

TRY IT Choose a quiet place and pray for two minutes today.

The Kingdom Message Cannot Be Stopped

THE MESSAGE

is greater than

ONE MESSENGER

John was put in prison—but the Gospel continued through Jesus.

VERSE 15

“The time is fulfilled, and the kingdom of God is at hand. Repent, and believe in the gospel.”

People expected a war-ready king. Jesus brought a counter-cultural Kingdom built on repentance and faith.



Jesus Calls Ordinary People

NOT THE RICHEST

NOT THE MOST EDUCATED

NOT THE MOST INFLUENTIAL

FISHERMEN

God's greatness shines through ordinary people.

1 Corinthians 1:27 "God chose the foolish things ... to shame the wise."



SIMON + ANDREW

casting their nets

JAMES + JOHN

boat + hired servants

DIFFERENT BACKGROUNDS

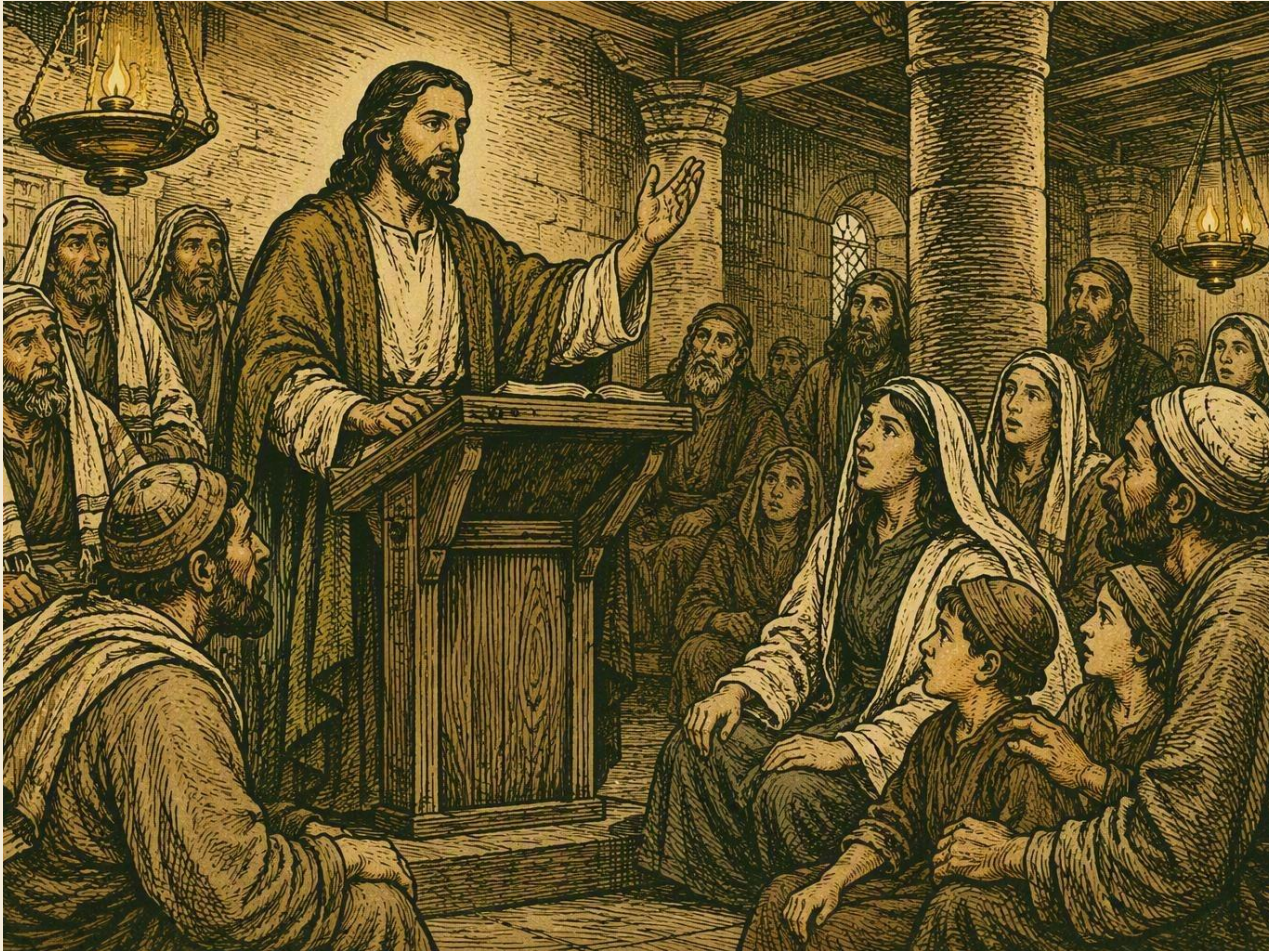
the same call

FOLLOW ME

They left immediately.

REFLECT Are you a full-time follower of Jesus at school?

“Immediately” Means the Message Matters



IMMEDIATELY

Jesus did not waste time.
The Good News was urgent.

THEY WERE ASTONISHED

Jesus taught with authority—not like
someone repeating another teacher.

AUTHORITY

His words carried the power of the
Son of God.

DISCUSS Do we feel urgency to learn and share God’s Word?

Jesus Has Absolute Authority

An unclean spirit tried to interrupt worship.

Inside the synagogue, opposition tried to distract, hinder, and oppose Christ.

**“I KNOW WHO YOU ARE—
THE HOLY ONE OF GOD!”**

JESUS OF NAZARETH

Nazareth sounded ordinary. The title did not hide who Jesus truly is.

**“BE QUIET,
AND COME OUT!”**

The spirit had to obey. Jesus’ power is absolute.

Even an enemy had to admit the truth: Jesus is the Holy One of God.

LOOK CLOSER What tried to distract people from Jesus—and what happened?

His Hand Heals and Restores

FAME did not change His mission.

Jesus went from the synagogue to the humble home of His fisherman disciple.

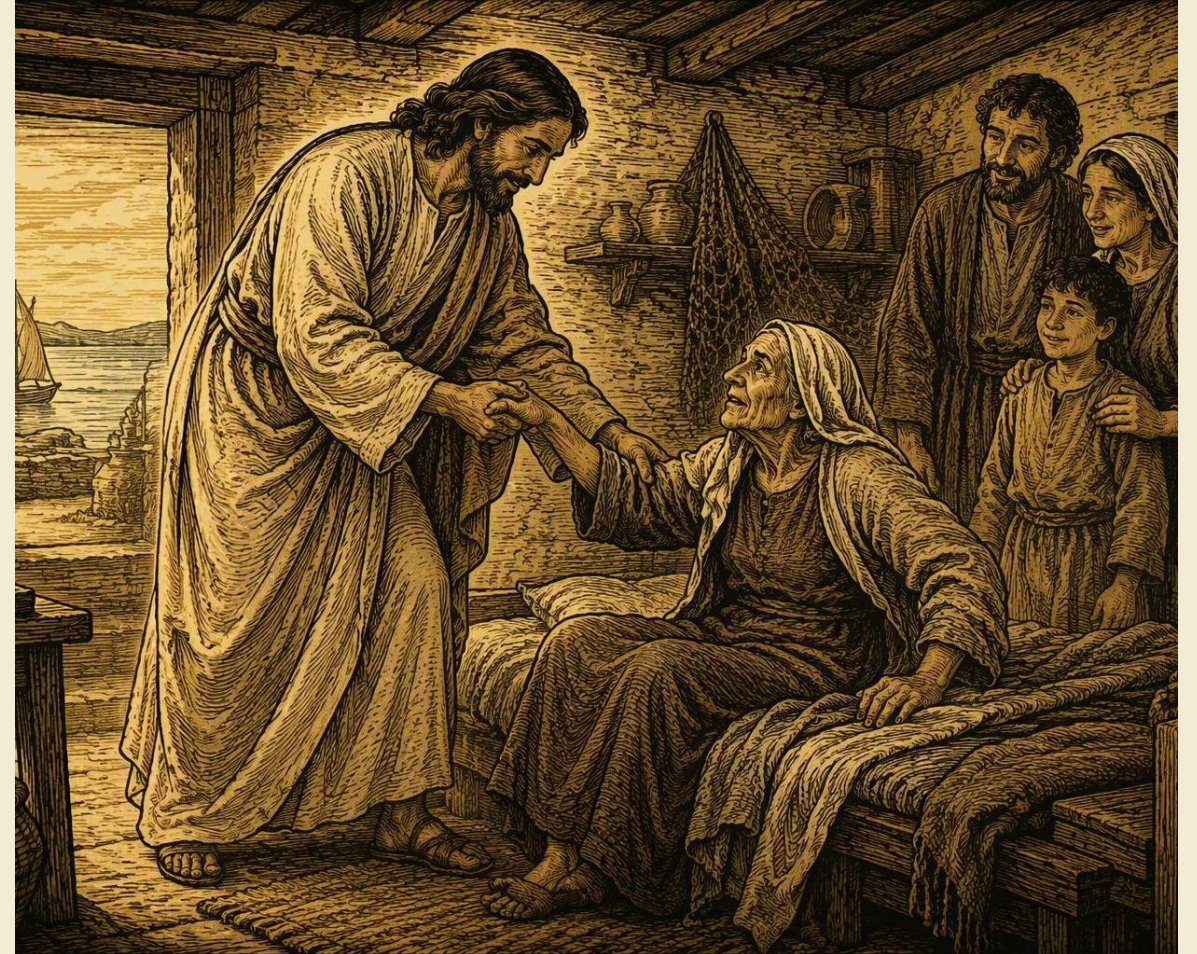
VERSES 30-31

“He took her by the hand and lifted her up, and immediately the fever left her.”

THE SAME HAND

**that healed her
also restored her strength.**

Complete healing meant she could rise and serve.



Jesus Welcomes the Whole City

ALL
were welcome.

The sick. The suffering. The overlooked. The entire city gathered at the door.

Jesus loved without picking favorites. He cared for everyone who came to Him.

He silenced the demons; they did not get to control His story.



REFLECT Who around you needs patient, Christ-like care?

Prayer Keeps Purpose Clear



PRAY → LISTEN → GO → PREACH

Before daylight

Jesus chose a solitary place—private prayer without distractions.

“Everyone is looking for You”

Popularity did not trap Him in one hometown.

For all Galilee

His purpose was to bring the Gospel to everyone.

Compassion Reaches the Untouchable

- 1 HE KNEELS *humility*
- 2 HE BELIEVES *firm faith*
- 3 HE ASKS *“If You are willing ...”*

JESUS IS MOVED WITH COMPASSION.

He touches the man and speaks:

**“I AM WILLING. BE
CLEANSED.”**

His mercy is the source of healing. His words carry the power that created the world.



Obedience Matters After the Miracle



JESUS SAID

GO TO THE PRIEST.

Follow what Moses commanded. Let the cleansing be a testimony.

THE MAN SPREAD THE NEWS

Jesus did not chase fame—but the crowds became so large that He stayed outside the city.

FAITH RECEIVES MERCY.

OBEDIENCE HONORS THE GIFT.

Faith opens our hearts to receive what Jesus gives; unbelief can close us off.

Mark 1 in Five Actions

The chapter begins in the wilderness and ends with people coming from every direction.



PREPARE

**Make His paths
straight.**



REPENT

Turn toward God.



FOLLOW

**Leave the nets
behind.**



PRAY

Find quiet with God.



SERVE

**Show Christ's
compassion.**

THIS WEEK AT SCHOOL

Choose one action. Ask Jesus to help you live it fully.